



Pharm*Achieve*

CLINICAL AUDITS

Qualifying Exam Preparatory Course

COMPETENCIES COVERED IN THIS PRESENTATION...

Providing Care:
Clinical Care

Providing Care:
Distribution

Knowledge
& Expertise

Communication
& Collaboration

Leadership &
Stewardship

Professionalism

OBJECTIVES

- ✓ Understand what an audit is
- ✓ Identify key steps in conducting an audit
- ✓ Determine how to analyze results and implement changes
- ✓ Recognize challenges when completing an audit
- ✓ Design a sample audit

WHAT IS AN AUDIT?

- Process of assessing adherence to standards/expectations, to ensure they are met or exceeded
- Consists of collecting data and analyzing it, assessing if change is required/improvements can be made, implementing changes and reviewing outcomes

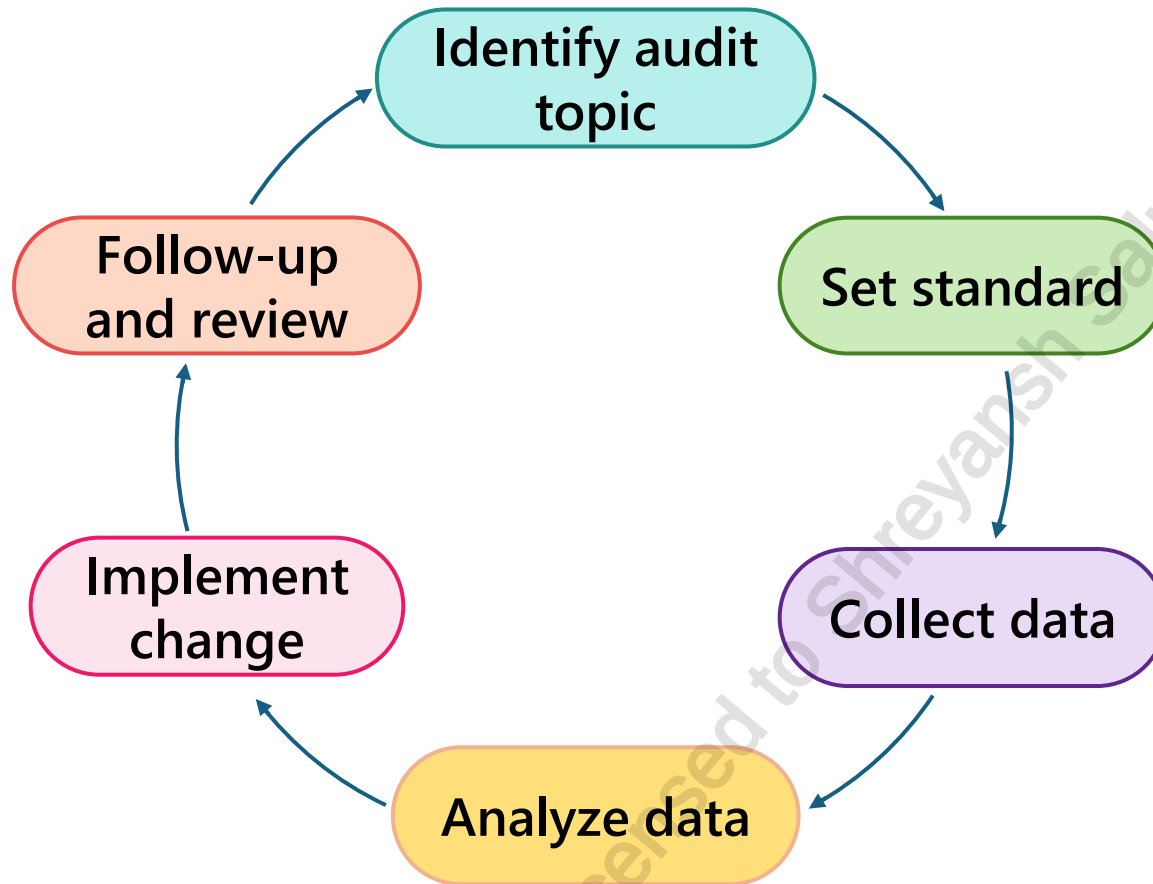


PURPOSE OF AUDITS

- Facilitate continuous quality improvement and accountability
- Identify and mitigate risks



AUDIT CYCLE



EXAMPLES OF AUDITS

- Cancer outpatient treatment times
- Elastomeric pump infusion times
- Opioid prescribing practices
- Narcotic count audits
- Antibiotic prescribing
- Cancer screening uptake
- Venous thromboembolism rates
- Patient falls
- Antipsychotic prescribing in patients with dementia



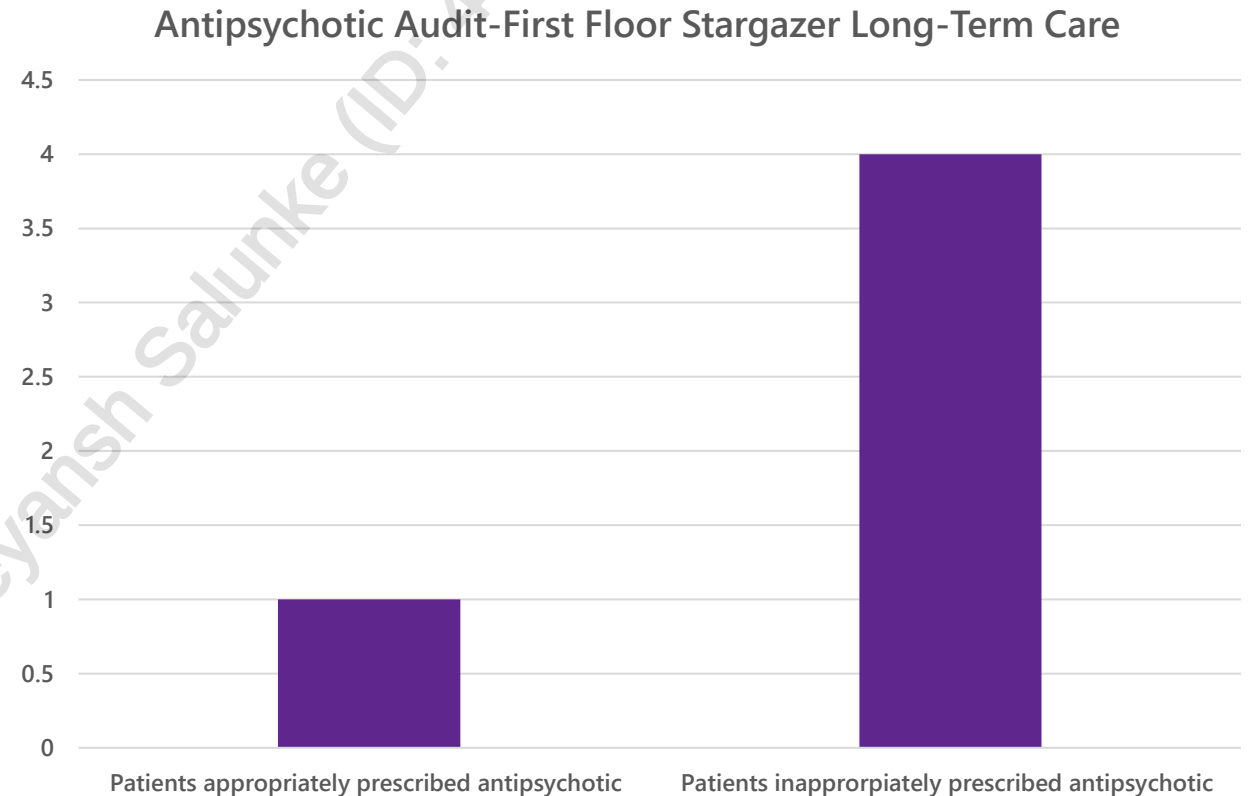
DATA COLLECTION

Antipsychotic Use Audit First Floor-Stargazer Long-Term Care

Patient	Antipsychotic use	Antipsychotic	Diagnosis of dementia	Dementia type	Behaviours exhibited	Interventions tried prior to antipsychotic use
D.F	Y	Risperidone	Y	Vascular	Shouting	Redirection to reading, watching tv, talking to staff
G.K	N	-----	Y	Alzheimer's	Sun-downing	Trazodone
N.L	Y	Risperidone	Y	Alzheimer's	Violent with staff	Citalopram, mirtazapine, redirection, different staff members
V.B	Y	Olanzapine	Y	Lewy Body	Hallucinations	Risperidone
L.O	Y	Loxapine	Y	Alzheimer's	Crying	2-month trial citalopram

ANALYZE DATA AND IMPLEMENT CHANGE

- Antipsychotics should generally be avoided in elderly patients with dementia as they can worsen psychosis and increase mortality.
- They should only be used if the patient has tried other interventions and not had symptom relief, if the patient is at risk of harm to themselves or others and if the patient is very troubled by the symptoms.
- The reason for antipsychotic use must be clearly documented in the patient's notes in addition to other interventions tried.
- Both physicians must independently assess the patient before starting an antipsychotic.



On the first floor, only 1 patient was appropriately prescribed an antipsychotic (N.L).

AUDIT REPORT

Introduction

- Background information on the problem, standard/objective
- Declare any conflicts of interest

Purpose/Aims

- Why is this audit being conducted?

Method

- How was the data collected and recorded?
- Which questions were asked?

Results

- Figures like graphs and charts
- Tables

Analysis/Discussion

- What do these results mean?
- What will be done with this data?
- How will this impact practice? Do changes need to be made to existing practice?
- What are the limitations of the audit? How can they be mitigated? How much do they impact the results?

Conclusion

- What is the outcome and what does that mean for current practice?
- Is a follow-up audit necessary?

References

- Sources consulted

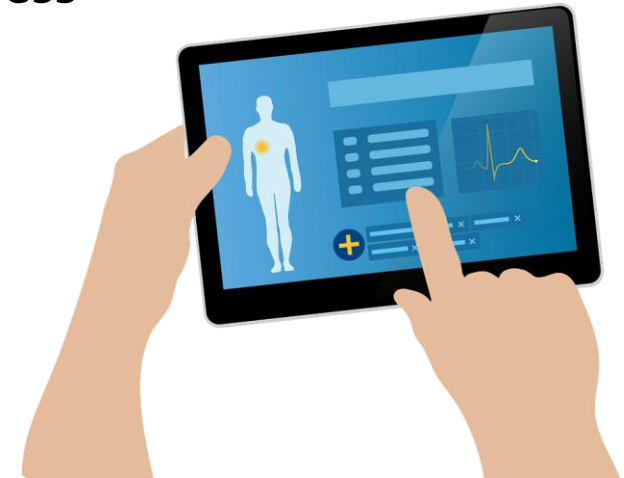
AUDIT PRESENTATION

- Share results with key stakeholders
- Can be presented during hospital Rounds, Professional Advisory Committee (PAC) meeting in Long-Term Care facility, etc.
- Use graphs, figures and tables
- Ask audience for feedback and ideas



TIPS

- Audit aims and objectives should be clear and specific
- Team lead should have a background in the area studied
- Collaborate with others
- Review other audits on related topics
- Set timeframes for collecting, analyzing and presenting data
- Data collection should be streamlined and efficient (use tablets on the unit, checklists, tables, etc.)
- Re-audit after the change has been implemented to assess progress



Practice

Your turn!

Let's brainstorm an audit idea together
and go through the steps



EXAMPLE

Licensed to Shreyansh Salunke (ID: 4477)

REFERENCES

1. A Brief Introduction to the Clinical Audit Cycle. nhs.uk. Accessed August 14, 2024. https://www.uhbristol.nhs.uk/media/2978735/2_introduction_to_the_clinical_audit_cycle_v4.pdf.
2. A Step-By-Step Guide Maximizing the Effectiveness of Clinical Audits. Canadian Association of Radiologists. Published January 2011. Accessed August 14, 2024. <https://car.ca/wp-content/uploads/CAR-Guide-Clinical-Audit.pdf>.
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CHANGE LOG

August 2025

- Content reviewed, no changes made

October 2025

- Minor formatting edits made

March 2026

- Slide 2: Updated NAPRA competencies
- No content changes made